

EYFS Maths Mastery Mapping

Planning and Continuous Provision Ideas

Adult-Led Activity Ideas	Questions and Prompts to Deepen Understanding
Exploring Maps • Provide a selection of maps for children to look at. Make sure there are a variety of features and landmarks that the children would recognise, such as roads, railways and forests. • Include maps and plans of different kinds, including thematic maps, such as public transport routes or theme park plans, aerial views, physical and road maps. • Encourage the children to explore the maps and talk about what they can see. • Can they follow a route with their finger? Where does the road go? What would they see along a route?	What can you see on the map? Can you describe where... is on the map? Which map do you like the most? Why? Can you see a forest/road/railway/river/building? What makes you think that's what it is? Can you trace along the road/railway with your finger? Where does it go? What would you see if you made that journey? Can you see somewhere people might live?
Make a Park Model from a Map • Provide a simple map of a park. This could be one that the children know or you could use this Small World Park Map. • Invite children to explore the map and talk about the features. • Offer a selection of recycled materials for junk modelling and invite children to create a model of the park based on the map. • They could use small world figures to explore the model once it is made and relate where the figures are to the position on the map.	What can you see on the map? Can you describe what you would see if you walked around the park? What could we use in order to make a model of the map? Where will the swing go? What is next to the roundabout? Where is the person? Can you show where that is on the map?

Adult-Led Activity Ideas

Questions and Prompts to Deepen Understanding

Map the Outside Area

- Take the children on a walk around your outside area.
- Discuss what they see on their walk and where the different features of the outside area are located. Use positional language to describe them.
- Invite children to close their eyes and visualise the outside area. Can they visualise the same walk?
- Encourage them to talk through what they will need to include if they draw a map of the outside area.
- Then, provide them with paper and mark-making tools and ask them to draw a map of the area.

What can you see on our walk?

What can you remember seeing?

Where was the ____?

What features did we notice in the outside area?

What was the first thing we walked past? What did we see next?

Did we see the climbing frame before or after the tree?

Can we draw the things we saw on our map?

Can you use the map to describe the journey?

Create a Map for a Traditional Tales Character

- Read a traditional tale that involves a journey, such as 'Little Red Riding Hood' or 'Jack and the Beanstalk'.
- Provide small world materials for children to create a setting for the story and encourage them to act the story out.
- Then, offer a large sheet of paper and encourage children to draw a map of the story.
- Encourage the children to draw key landmarks and features from the story and think about where these may be in relation to each other.
- Children can use the map to describe the story character's journey and the location of the key events that happen during the story.

Where does the story begin?

Where else does the character visit?

Can you draw this on the map?

Are these places near to their home or far away?

Can you draw these places?

How did they get there? What did they see on the way?

Can you describe the character's journey through the map?

Could we change the story by adding something else to the map?

What if Little Red Riding Hood came to a broken bridge - is there a different way she could go?

Adult-Led Activity Ideas

Digging Deeper: Follow and Create Treasure Maps

- Hide some pirate treasure in the outdoor area and create a treasure map for the children, with the site of the treasure marked on it. Encourage them to discuss which area each part of the map is showing and then follow the map to find 'X marks the spot' to uncover the treasure.
- Then, invite children to create their own treasure maps. Provide them with some pirate coins. Encourage them to hide the coins in the setting and draw a map to show their location. Can they share the map with their friends and challenge them to locate the coins?

Questions and Prompts to Deepen Understanding

What does the map show?

What can you see on this part of the map?

Can you describe the route you need to take to find the treasure?

Where did you find the treasure?

How did the map help you?

Where will you hide the coins?

What do you need to add to your map to show your friends how to find the coins?

Which route will your friend need to take?

What will they go past?

Enhanced Provision Ideas

- Use this [Guiding Teddy Home Map Cutting Skills Activity](#). Encourage children to place landmarks on the map and then describe Teddy's journey home.
- Explore this [Traditional Fairy Tales Map Poster](#) with the children and describe where the characters and buildings are. Can the children describe a journey? Can they create a model based on the map using recycled materials?
- Offer these [Seaside Fine Motor Pencil Control Mazes](#) and encourage the children to trace their way through the mazes with their finger or with a pencil.
- Encourage children to build their own maze using building blocks. Then, can they guide a small world figure through it and describe the route?
- Produce a plan showing an obstacle course using small and large apparatus. Can the children follow the plan and collaborate to build the obstacle course?
- Provide children with [Role-Play Maps](#) and real maps showing the local area. Children can explore the maps and talk about key features that they can see.
- Encourage children to paint or draw maps of journeys taken in familiar stories.
- Offer basic maps and ask children to position key features on the maps using bricks, blocks or small world items.
- Invite children to draw a map of their bedroom or kitchen or to create a map of a room for a book character.
- Provide a map of the world. Encourage children to point out places they have visited or where they have family connections. Children might also match photos or postcards to different countries.



Key Questions

- What can you see on the map?
- Which map do you like the most? Why?
- Where can you see ____?
- Can you describe where ____ is?
- I wonder what you might see on the journey.
- What do you/they go past first? What do you/they pass next?
- Can you draw a map to show the journey in the story? What do you need to show on the map?
- Are those two things near or far from each other?
- What is next to/behind/under it?
- Can you copy this plan to make a model/obstacle course?
- Can you follow the map?
- How do you know which way to go?
- Where does your map take you?
- Tell me about the route.
- Which places can you see on the map?
- What maze will you build? How will the figure move through the maze?
- How can you make a model to go with this map?



Disclaimer: To ensure the safety of the children in your setting, it is your responsibility to assess whether adult supervision or other appropriate safety measures are required when carrying out any of these activities.